

Kanban is based on three basic principles:

1. Visualize what you do today (the workload that you have): Viewing all items in context of each other can be helpful.
2. Limit the amount of work in progress: This helps in balancing the flow-based approach so teams don't start and commit too much work at once, making it difficult to complete or some all of them in time.
3. Enhance flow: When some work is completed, the next important thing from the backlog is pulled into play.

One can apply Kanban principles to any process they are already run-



Kanban board

ning. In Kanban, work is organized on a Kanban board. The board has columns which depict states that every work item passes through – from left to right. Work items are pulled along through the in progress, testing, ready for release, and released columns.

A basic kanban board has a three-step workflow: To Do, In Progress, and Done. However, depending on a team's size, structure, and objectives, the workflow can be mapped to meet the unique process of any particular team.

For every column (state) on the Kanban board “Work In Progress”-Limit (WIP Limit) should be defined. The WIP limit depicts how much work items are allowed to be in a certain state at any given point in time. If a state reaches its pre-defined WIP limit, no new work can enter that state. The whole team has to help clear the filled up state first. Work items trapped in a state will build highly visible clusters on the Kanban board. These